

Lesson 46: “Zion—The Pure in Heart” (See L46 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand what the scriptures teach about Zion and to inspire us in our efforts to establish Zion. †1. The Prophet Joseph Smith †2. Elder Alexander B. Morrison

1. The word *Zion* has several meanings.

- a. [D&C 97:21](#). (The pure in heart.) †3. Brigham Young
- b. [D&C 82:14](#). (The Church and its stakes.)
- c. [Moses 7:19](#). (The city of Enoch.)
- d. [2 Samuel 5:6-7](#); [1 Kings 8:1](#). (The ancient city of Jerusalem.) †4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie
- e. [D&C 45:66-67](#); [57:1-2](#); [Articles of Faith 1:10](#). (The New Jerusalem, which will be built in Missouri.)
- f. [Hebrews 12:22-23](#). (The dwelling place of those who are exalted.)

“In this lesson, when we speak of building Zion in our day, we are referring to purifying our hearts so that the places we live can be called Zion.” (*Lesson Manual*) †5. Elder Alexander B. Morrison

2. Zion has existed in previous dispensations.

- Moses [7:12-19, 68-69](#). “And so great was the faith of Enoch ... he spake the word of the Lord, and the earth trembled”. What does it mean to be “of one heart and one mind”?
 - [Moses 7:61-63](#). The Saints will be gathered to “an Holy City ... and it shall be called Zion, a New Jerusalem... And the Lord said unto Enoch: Then shalt thou and all thy city meet them there”.
- Why is the account of Enoch and his people important to us today?

3. The Saints of our dispensation have been commanded to establish Zion.

“One of the most frequently mentioned subjects in the Doctrine and Covenants is the establishing of Zion in the latter days. There are more than 200 references to Zion in these revelations. Some of these refer to a physical location, some to a condition of the heart, and some to building the Lord’s Church. Even before the Church was formally organized, the Lord directed a number of brethren to “seek to bring forth and establish the cause of Zion” ([D&C 6:6](#); [11:6](#); [12:6](#); [14:6](#)). (*LM*) †6. Zion in Missouri Why were the early Saints unable to build the city of Zion? (See [D&C 101:6-8](#); [105:1-12](#).)

Why is it so important to develop pure, loving, wise, united and unselfish hearts? †7. President Harold B. Lee

- Read [D&C 82:14-15](#). “For Zion must increase in beauty, and in holiness; her borders must be enlarged”.

What are some specific things we should do to build Zion?

- [D&C 97:21](#). **Strive to become pure in heart.** (See [Moroni 7:47-48](#); [10:32](#).)
 - [D&C 38:27](#). **Become unified.** What are some effective ways to become more unified in our families and ward?
 - [D&C 64:34-35](#); [105:3, 5-6](#). **Be obedient.** How have you been strengthened by obedience to gospel principles?
 - [D&C 105:3](#). **Care for the poor and afflicted.** Why is caring for the needy a necessary part of building Zion?
 - [D&C 97:10-16](#). **Build temples and receive the blessings of the temple.**
- Why is temple work so important? (See [D&C 97:13-16](#); [105:9-12](#).)
- [D&C 105:10](#). **Teach one another and learn our duties more perfectly.**
- How can we improve teaching in our families and our wards? In what areas do we need further learning?
- [D&C 133:8-9](#). **Preach the gospel to the world.** How does preaching the gospel change and strengthen us?

4. The scriptures include glorious promises about the future of Zion.

- a. [D&C 97:18-25](#). What are some blessings promised to Zion?

What must we do to enjoy these blessings? (See [D&C 97:25](#).)

- †8. John Taylor †9. Brigham Young †10. Elder Robert D. Hales
- †11. Elder Robert D. Hales †12. President Gordon B. Hinckley

Next Week: Something about our Lord Jesus Christ and the Christmas Season. [Class Member Study Guide](#).

For the first week in the year 2014 the lesson will be: Click on [Lesson 1](#): “This Is My Work and My Glory.” (You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Old Testament Manual: Religion 301 and 302](#).) † •

†1. **The Prophet Joseph Smith:** “We ought to have the building up of Zion as our greatest object. ... The time is soon coming, when no man will have any peace but in Zion and her stakes” (Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith, sel. Joseph Fielding Smith [1976], 160–61).

†2. **Elder Alexander B. Morrison:** “The dream of a better world is as old as mankind. From time immemorial, men and women of faith and hope have dreamed of a Holy City, whose king is the Lord God Omnipotent; a place of refuge for the righteous fleeing the storms of a wicked world; an abode where peace is in every heart, where there is no fear nor want and all people are brothers and sisters, where faith and purity shine in every face. That place, in Judeo-Christian parlance, is called Zion.” (*Visions of Zion*, 1)

†3. **Brigham Young:** “As to the spirit of Zion, it is in the hearts of the Saints, of those who love and serve the Lord with all their might, mind, and strength.” (*Journal of Discourses*, 2:253)

†4. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “The New Jerusalem to be built in Jackson County, Missouri, is also called the City of Zion or Zion. Dozens of revelations in the Doctrine and Covenants speak about this Zion. Isaiah and other of the ancient prophets have much to say both about it and about the Jerusalem of old which shall be restored in grandeur and beauty in the last days. These two great cities, dual world capitals, are needed to fulfill the great millennial promise: ‘Out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of the Lord from Jerusalem.’ (Isa. 23).” (*Mormon Doctrine*, 855)

†5. **Elder Alexander B. Morrison:** “In its complete sense, then, Zion remains for us the golden, flawless ideal, the dream of what we may become if we are worthy, the goal toward which we must labor, the paradise which though now lost may yet be regained. The dream of establishing Zion thus is a dream of perfection that deals with the conquest of the heart rather than the constructing buildings or paving streets with gold. It calls us to subdue and purify our passions, to overcome the carnality of the natural man; and to become ‘as a child, submissive, meek, humble, patient, full of love, willing to submit to all things which the Lord seeth fit to inflict upon [us], even as a child doth submit to his father’.” (*Visions of Zion*, 16-17)

†6. **Zion in Missouri.** “For the early Saints, establishing Zion not only meant becoming pure in heart and living in unity. It also meant building the city of Zion, or New Jerusalem. In July 1831, the Lord revealed to the Prophet Joseph Smith that the city of Zion should be built in Missouri, with Independence as the center place ([D&C 57:1–3](#)). After this revelation,

many Saints gathered to Missouri. They prospered for a time, but contentions and divisions soon arose among them. There were also tensions with other settlers in the area. In November 1833, mobs drove the Saints from their homes. A few months later, in July 1834, the Lord revealed that the Saints would have to ‘wait a little season for the redemption of Zion’” (*Lesson Manual*)

†7. **President Harold B. Lee:** “The borders of Zion, where the righteous and pure in heart may dwell, must now begin to be enlarged. The stakes of Zion must be strengthened. All this so that Zion may arise and shine by becoming increasingly diligent in carrying out the plan of salvation throughout the world” (“[Strengthen the Stakes of Zion](#),” *Ensign*, July 1973, 3).

†8. **John Taylor:** “And do not be figuring for yourselves and for your own aggrandizement; but feel to say in your hearts, ‘What can I do to help to build up Zion. I am here, and everything that I have got is upon the altar, and I am prepared to do the will of God no matter what it may be, or where it sends me, to the ends of the earth or not.’” (*Journal of Discourses*, 21:254)

†9. **Brigham Young:** “When we conclude to make a Zion, we will make it, and this work commences in the heart of each person. When the father of a family wishes to make a Zion in his own house, he must take the lead in this good work, which it is impossible for him to do unless he himself possesses the spirit of Zion. Before he can produce the work of sanctification in his family, he must sanctify himself, and by this means God can help him to sanctify his family.” (*Discourses of Brigham Young*, 118)

Recommended reading:

1. Elder Bruce R. McConkie, “[Obedience, Consecration, and Sacrifice](#),” *Ensign*, May 1975.
2. Elder Robert D. Hales, “[Welfare Principles to Guide our Lives: An Eternal Plan for the Welfare of Men’s Souls](#),” *Ensign*, May 1986.
3. Elder Robert D. Hales, “[Return with Honor](#),” *Ensign*, June 1999.

Recommended Media:

1. Video: “[Zion: A Destination and a Process](#)” (:39)

Visit stephenmbird.com

†10. Elder Robert D. Hales: Straying off course

I was taught about vertigo when my Air Force instructor took me up in an airplane with the cockpit covered by a canopy so I could not see outside. I would have to rely on the instruments. Unknown to me, he gradually turned the airplane upside down, keeping positive G forces. My ear did not detect the slow rollover. He told me to take control of the airplane. Of course, I did what every other student did. I pulled backwards because I was losing altitude, and, of course, I started a dive toward the earth because I did not know I was upside down.

As I started to regain control of the airplane, I could see the little marks on the landing gear were upside down. My instructor taught me the principle that you can take a human being at a two- or three-degree turn while keeping positive G forces and turn them upside down without their knowing they have left the straight and level flight. The motion is imperceptible.

If we are not careful, we can experience spiritual vertigo. If we stray off the course of obedience by only two or three almost imperceptible degrees, we can become disoriented and lose sight of our eternal destination, not even realizing how far off course we are. We will then make poor choices. Just as my airplane left straight and level flight degree by degree, if we stray from the straight and narrow path even degree by degree, we can become confused and lose sight of our eternal goal.

Our Savior does not want us to crash. His desire is for us to choose the right course that will bring us back on the straight and narrow path to live with Him eternally. “Come, follow me,” He has told us ([Luke 18:22](#)). He provides the light that will keep us on course and bring us back into His presence. (“[Return with Honor](#),” *New Era*, Nov. 2001)

†11. Elder Robert D. Hales: “The welfare plan builds a Zion People. Zion is characterized in scripture as a city in which the people “were of one heart and one mind, and dwelt in righteousness; and there was no poor among them.” (Moses 7:18.) Zion is “every man seeking the interest of his neighbor, and doing all things with an eye single to the glory of God.” (D&C 82:19.) This promised Zion always seems to be a little beyond our reach. We need to understand that as much virtue can be gained in progressing toward Zion as in dwelling there. It is a process as well as a destination. We approach or withdraw from Zion through the manner in which we conduct our daily dealings, how we live within our families, whether we pay an honest tithe and generous fast offering, how we seize

opportunities to serve and do so diligently. Many are perfected upon the road to Zion who will never see the city in mortality.” (“[Welfare Principles to Guide our Lives: An Eternal Plan for the Welfare of Men’s Souls](#),” *Ensign*, May 1986)

†12. President Gordon B. Hinckley: “I see a wonderful future in a very uncertain world. If we will cling to our values, if we will build on our inheritance, if we will walk in obedience before the Lord, if we will simply live the gospel, we will be blessed in a magnificent and wonderful way. We will be looked upon as a peculiar people who have found the key to a peculiar happiness.

“ ‘And many people shall go and say, Come ye, and let us go up to the mountain of the Lord....: for out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of the Lord from Jerusalem’ (Isaiah 2:3)

“Great has been our past, wonderful is our present, glorious can be our future.” (“[Look to the Future](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997, 69)

Visit stephenmbird.com